

U.S. officials warn Musk blitz may be against law

Many privately sound alarms over DOGE attack on federal agencies

This article is by Jeff Stein, Dan Diamond, Faiz Siddiqui, Cat Zakrzewski, Hannah Natanson and Jacqueline Alemany

The chaotic blitz by Elon Musk's Department of Government Efficiency has triggered legal objections across Washington, with officials in at least a half-dozen federal agencies and departments raising alarms about whether the billionaire's assault on government is breaking the law.

Over the past two weeks, Musk's team has moved to dismantle some U.S. agencies, push out hundreds of thousands of civil servants and gain access to some of the federal government's most sensitive payment systems. Musk has said these changes are necessary to overhaul what he's characterized as a sclerotic federal bureaucracy and to stop payments that he says are bankrupting the country and driving inflation.

But many of these moves appear to violate federal law, according to more than two dozen current and former officials, one

SEE MUSK ON A10

What happened on Tuesday

The Senate confirmed Pam Bondi as attorney general.

Two committees advanced the nominations of Robert F. Kennedy Jr. as HHS secretary and Tulsi Gabbard as director of national intelligence. **A4**

The U.S. Postal Service halted inbound packages from China and Hong Kong, and China put its own economic weapons to use. **A15**

Move Gazans to another country, Trump urges



DEMETRIUS FREEMAN/THE WASHINGTON POST

President Donald Trump on Tuesday proposed that Gaza Strip residents be moved to another nation and that the United States lead a redevelopment of the territory. At the White House with Trump, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said he was open to the idea.

Flight path at National leaves little room for error

Plane that crashed was using a landing strip approach that takes jets within feet of a helicopter corridor

BY AARON C. DAVIS, SARAH BLASKEY AND ANDREW BA TRAN

When visibility is good, pilots of regional airline jets bound for Reagan National Airport expect to hear a familiar request from air traffic control as they fly north up the Potomac River: Can the flight crew divert to Runway 33?

Pilots who agree initiate a swooping turn that on final approach brings them northwest

and low across the river — the path American Eagle Flight 5342 was on last week when it and a U.S. Army helicopter collided.

While the primary approaches to the airport's main runway provide jets with hundreds of feet of clearance over the busy helicopter corridors that run along the Potomac, there is no such cushion for Runway 33.

The charted approach for that alternative landing takes jets within 15 feet of the top of the

Route 4 helicopter corridor as it is depicted in navigation maps, according to a Washington Post analysis of Federal Aviation Administration documentation.

With little margin for error, the design places intense responsibility on air traffic controllers and helicopter pilots to stay clear of jets navigating a low and highly technical approach to the airport's shortest landing strip, experts said. Several airplane pilots interviewed by The Post

described close encounters with helicopters while approaching Runway 33, and other pilots have filed reports about such incidents to a federal aviation safety database.

The helicopter route and landing path for the runway essentially put aircraft "in the same place," said Scott Dunham, who has

SEE DCA ON A12

Retrieval: The remains of all 67 victims have been recovered. **B1**

PROPOSES THAT U.S. CONTROL ENCLAVE

In an age-old conflict, president risks new furor

BY MATT VISER AND MICHAEL BIRNBAUM

President Donald Trump on Tuesday proposed that the United States take a "long-term ownership position" over Gaza, moving its residents to a "good, fresh, beautiful piece of land" in another country and developing the war-torn territory under U.S. control, offering a vision of mass displacement likely to inflame sentiments in the Arab world.

Trump's proposal, which he offered as he welcomed Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu to the White House, was likely to provoke a furious reaction from many Palestinians as well as their Arab allies in the region, since it suggested permanently removing Gaza's 2.2 million residents from Palestinian territory and settling them outside of their land. It would also pull the United States even more deeply into the conflict by taking over territory that belongs to Palestinians.

The idea was a first indicator of Trump's swaggering approach to the region, as he waded into a generations-old conflict with the assurance that he could resolve what years of efforts by U.S. diplomats have failed to accomplish.

His proposal appeared to give little consideration to what Palestinians have said they want.

"I don't think people should be going back to Gaza. I think that Gaza has been very unlucky for them," Trump said. "They've lived like hell. They lived like you're living in hell. Gaza is not a place for people to be living, and

SEE TRUMP ON A14

Ukraine: Kyiv welcomes Trump's interest in bartering for aid. **A16**

Decision looms: Federal workers face pressure to decide on offer. **B1**

D.C. Council unanimously expels White over bribery allegations

BY PAUL SCHWARTZMAN AND JENNY GATHRIGHT

The D.C. Council voted unanimously Tuesday to expel council member Trayon White Sr., a searing and unprecedented rebuke stemming from federal allegations that he took \$35,000 in bribes from a government contractor.

White's expulsion — the first imposed by the council in its 51-year history — forced the Democrat to immediately surrender his seat representing Ward 8, a swath of largely blue-collar neighborhoods east of the Anacostia River.

As the council voted 12-0 to remove him, White sat expressionless in the audience along-

side his attorney, Frederick D. Cooke, and a couple dozen of his supporters. White left the chambers after the vote, and did not answer a flurry of questions from reporters as he walked downstairs and disappeared into his office.

Soon after, White's nameplate was removed from the council dais. His name also was stripped

from his office door.

As his now-former colleagues continued with their meeting, White left the building, stopping for a moment to pose for photographs outside with supporters in front of a statue of Marion Barry, the former mayor who also represented Ward 8. He then drove away in his car; his official council license plates still in

place.

White, 40, who has pleaded not guilty to the federal bribery charge, is scheduled to go on trial next January. Prosecutors have maintained that they have video recordings that show him taking cash from the contractor.

Despite the council's action, White is eligible to run in a

SEE WHITE ON A9

Fear, pain, hunger for millions as aid dries up

BY KATHARINE HOURELD AND RACHEL CHASON

NAIROBI — Soup kitchens can no longer feed the hungry. First responders are unable to reach the dead and wounded. Mothers and fathers search in vain for the medicines that keep them alive.

Across Africa, in bombed-out Sudanese cities, Kenyan clinics and Mauritanian refugee camps, the policies of the Trump administration are already having profound consequences for some of the world's most vulnerable people.

The president's decision to cancel or suspend billions of dollars worth of foreign aid — followed by ill-defined exemptions — are deepening humanitarian crises and putting an untold number of lives at risk, according to front-line aid workers and civilians who rely on American-funded programs.

Last week, thousands of "stop-

SEE AID ON A16

In an Ohio community, drug deaths are falling

Decrease in fatal overdoses in Hamilton County is mirrored across much of the nation, offering hope

BY DAVID OVALLE IN CINCINNATI

One of Evelyn Tharp's sons died of a drug overdose. So did her brother. And two nephews and a niece. Her surviving son and daughter wrestle with severe mental illness and drug use.

Her family life is chaotic except for the presence of a Hamilton County outreach worker named Sarah Coyne.

Each week, Coyne drops by the family's home in the hardscrabble Price Hill neighborhood. She ferries Tharp's 44-year-old daughter to receive medication that treats opioid addiction. Coyne has arranged many stays at hospitals

and treatment centers for Tharp's 39-year-old son — and revived him multiple times after finding him unconscious from overdoses.

"He'd be dead if not for Sarah," Tharp, 67, said.

The story of Hamilton County, which includes Cincinnati, is the story of much of America at the start of 2025. Deaths from drug overdoses have fallen sharply, offering hope the crisis will further ease. Here, as in many communities ravaged by the opioid crisis, users are adapting to an evolving illicit drug supply dominated by potent fentanyl and often mixed with other synthetic drugs. At the same time, lifesaving antidotes flood the streets, and teams

SEE OHIO ON A3



MEGAN JELINGER FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Sarah Coyne, right, an outreach worker with the Hamilton County Quick Response Team, visits Evelyn Tharp, center, and her daughter, Tasha, in Cincinnati.

IN THE NEWS

Immigration crackdown Lawmakers in red states who back the White House's mass deportation plans are pursuing their own increasingly restrictive measures. **A8**

Art after an unbearable loss In the wake of a transgender friend's death, a woman began folding paper cranes to tell their story. **B1**

THE NATION **The legal principle** of unitary executive theory, the foundation of President Donald Trump's push for expanded power, could get a receptive ear at the Supreme Court. **A5**

THE WORLD **Dozens have died** after the collapse of a truce between Colombian drug-trafficking groups. **A13** **Mexico's president** is working to keep a "cool head" during the Trump administration. **A15**

THE ECONOMY **A Trump executive** order would cancel recent federal union contracts in a push against telework. Here's what workers should know. **A17** **Sign the deferred** resignation contract at your peril, columnist Michelle Singletary warns federal workers. **A18**

THE REGION **A ruling** effectively gives a historic Black D.C. church vandalized by the Proud Boys control of the group's name. **B1** **Virginia lawmakers** voted on everything from a casino plan to gun control to campaign contributions on their annual "crossover" day. **B1**

STYLE **Simone and Malcolm** Collins, the faces of a new pronatalist movement, want to make America procreate again. **C1**

FOOD **Southern California's** wildfires took everything from a family but their food trucks. So they fed their community. **E1**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A17
COMICS.....C7
OBITUARIES.....B5
OPINION PAGES.....A19
TELEVISION.....C6
WORLD NEWS.....A13

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54118

0 170628 211001 3